We use a with statement to take advantage of the fact that our code follows a happy path. Each step must be successful, and any deviation from success should be rolled back. Our first step is to create the SMS message. After that, we enqueue a job only if the created message matches the format we want.

Last, we return the message variable. The Repo.transaction/1 function wraps it in an ok tuple, so our final result is transformed into {:ok, message}.

This code block highlights something important about Oban. Because it is a Postgres-backed job system, you can use transactions to guarantee that your job doesn't execute until the data and any other jobs are enqueued. In Ruby's Sidekiq library, you need to use after_transaction hooks or other techniques to only enqueue jobs after the transaction is finalized. With Oban, you don't have to think about it.

We've successfully added this job into our app, and we managed to do so without changing much code.

Our Worker in Action

Start your phone_app application and also the included mock_server application. Remember, you start each of them using mix phx.server. (If you need a reminder on how to use the mock_server application, refer to the previous chapter.)

Visit http://localhost:4004/messages and create a new SMS message. Then visit the mock server at http://localhost:4005/, and you'll see your message there. You can reply back from here as well.

Our SMS app initially says that the message is queued—you'll see this in the user interface. After a short time (up to 20 seconds or so) refresh the page and you'll see that "queued" has disappeared and our system is properly recognizing the message as delivered.

This status update happened because of our job. Without it, the message would appear to be queued forever, which would be rather confusing for users!

Our job is basic, let's quickly go over some of the more advanced features that Oban provides.

More About Oban

Oban is easy to get started with, plus it provides several features that make it a powerful part of an application. Some of these features are open-source, but there's even a paid version that adds a lot of advanced functionality.